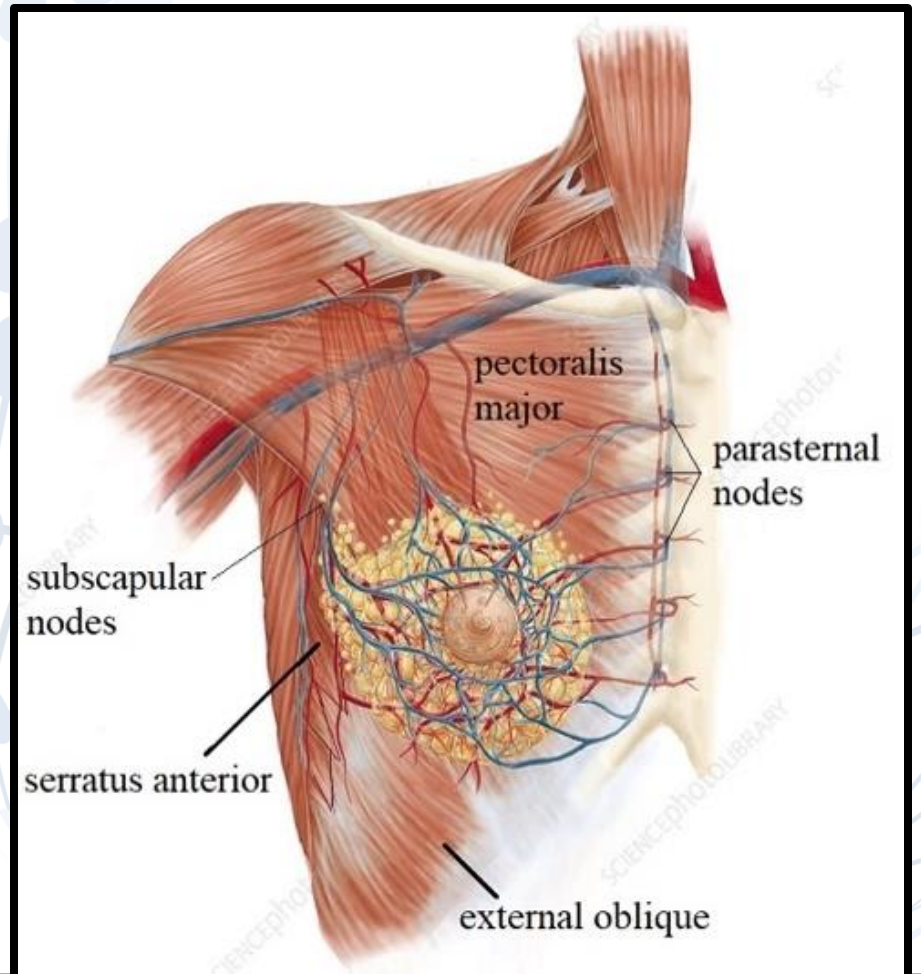
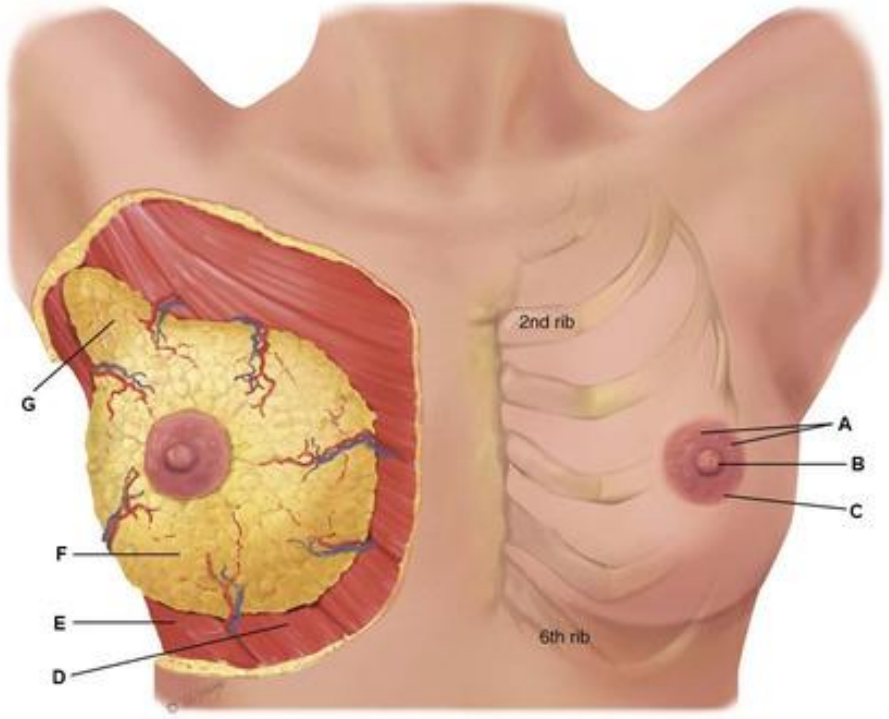
Base of the mammary gland

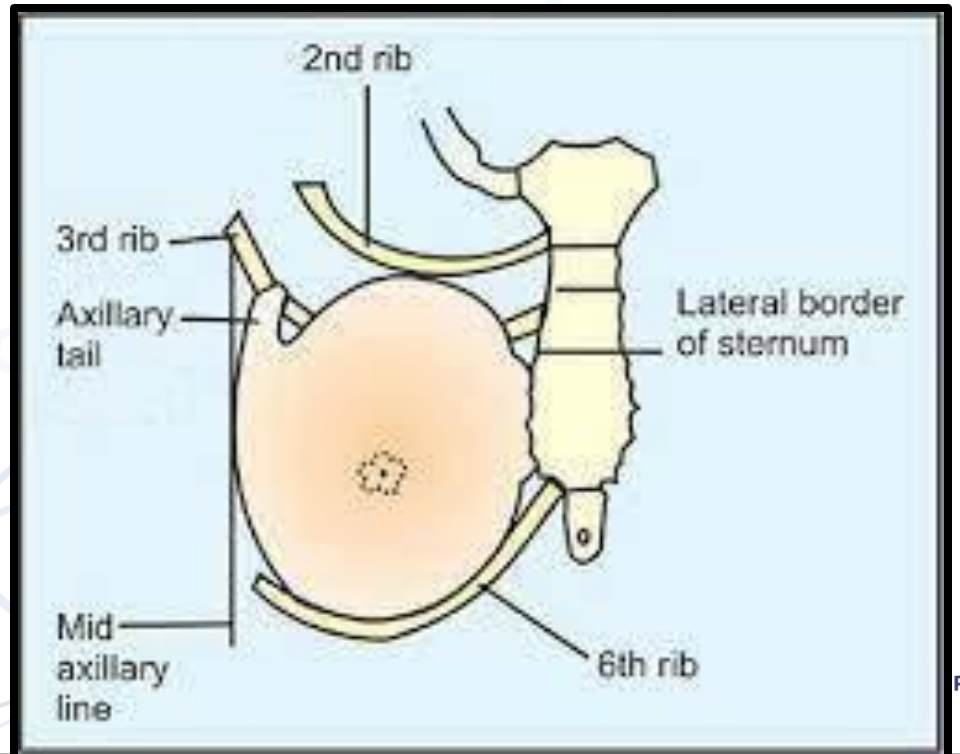
It rests on the **pectoralis major, serratus anterior and external oblique muscles.**



Base of the mammary gland

- It extends from the 2nd to the 6th ribs and from the sternal margin to the midaxillary line.
- The nipple lies opposite the 5th intercostal space in males and in females before puberty.

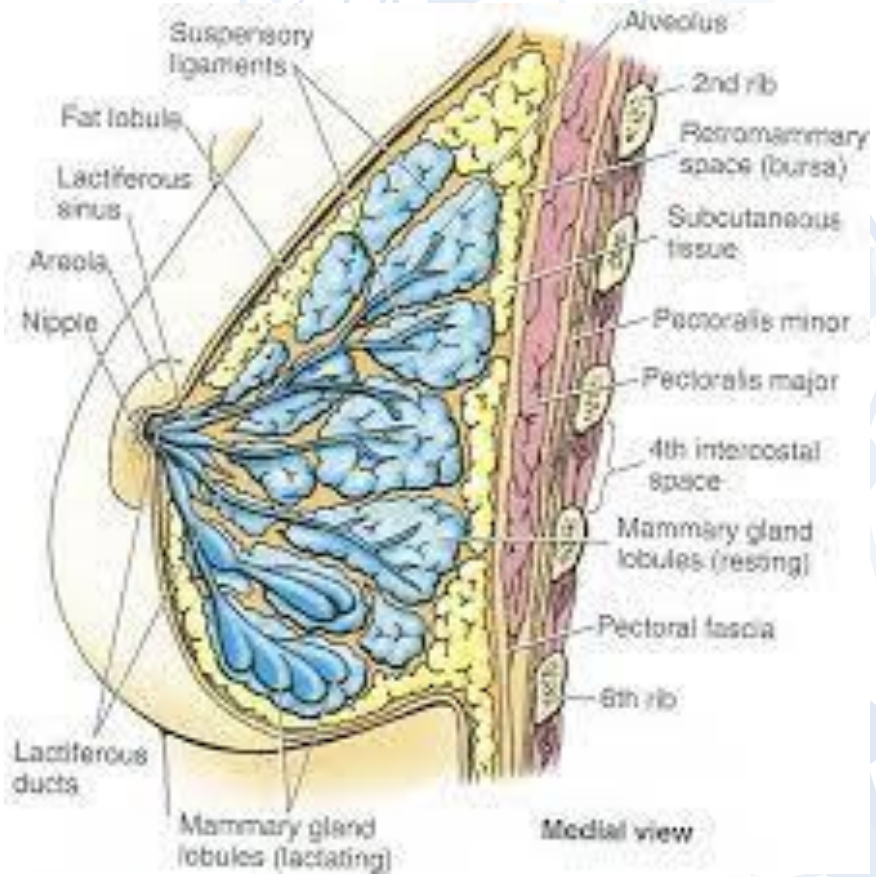




ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Base of the mammary gland

The breast is separated from the underlying muscles by a space called retro-mammary space containing loose areolar tissue that allows some degree of movements of the breast.



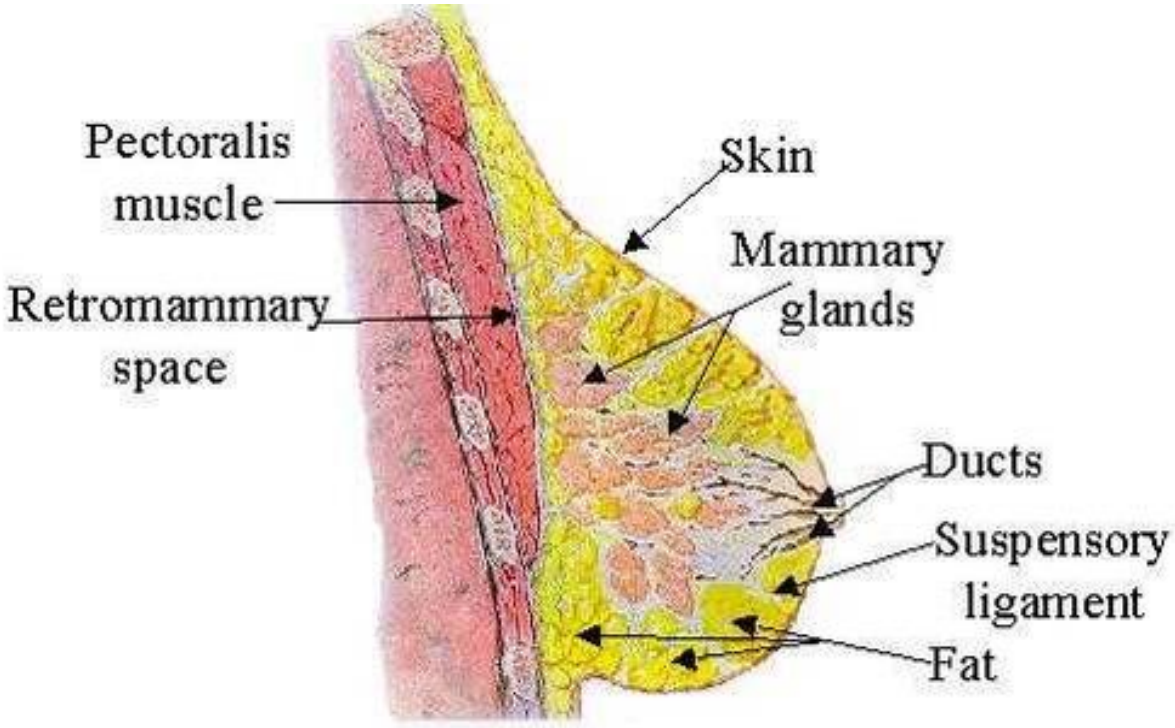


Figure 1. The female breast

Structure of the mammary gland

1. **Glandular tissue** which is divided into lobules by fibrous septa called suspensory ligaments. The ligaments extend from the deep fascia to the skin and help to support the breast tissue. A lactiferous duct arises from each lobule. The lactiferous ducts run in a radial direction to open on the nipple.
2. **Fatty tissue** into which the glandular tissue is embedded.
3. **Nipple:** is a protrusion on which the lactiferous ducts open.
4. **Areola:** a pigmented area of skin surrounding the nipple.

